deployed to production because these versions have been verified successfully.

10.2.2 Configuring branches

When introducing contract testing as part of a pull request or feature branch workflow, a problem that we've faced in the past was that the providers can sometimes verify the incorrect contract due to consumers uploading contracts that are still works in progress. For example, let's say the consumer is working on a feature that involves changing the contract. Because this is an early feature that is still a work in progress, a few changes still need to be iterated. However, because the changes are being committed to the pipeline, the contract testing workflow has started. The consumer pipeline fails, as expected, because the work is still in progress. On the provider pipeline, let's say that one of the developers is introducing some minor code changes too. The developer is confident it won't break the contract because the code change isn't a breaking change. The developer is surprised to find that their pull request is also failing because the provider verification has verified the incorrect contract.

To avoid situations where the verification process isn't accurate, branches in Pact were introduced to ensure providers verify the correct contracts. Branches represent your typical Git branches and often contain different versions, representing numerous commits on a branch. There are two situations in which branches are created in Pact:

- When the consumer publishes a contract
- When the provider verifies the contract

To configure a branch, you need to update the contract-test-sample.yaml file and introduce a new environment variable called `GITHUB_BRANCH`, which will contain the value of the GitHub branch. To do this in GitHub Actions, add the following code snippet:

```
env:
  PACT_BROKER_BASE_URL: ${{ secrets.PACT_BROKER_BASE_URL }}
  PACT_BROKER_TOKEN: ${{ secrets.PACT_BROKER_TOKEN }}
  GITHUB_SHA: ${{ github.sha }}
  GITHUB_BRANCH: ${{ github.ref_name }}
```